The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY KEY NUMBERS FROM THE INBOX ON X CYCLE TRACKER EVENTS

SOX (FRI CLOSE)
10,779.46 +0.44% · MU $877.55 (+2.46%) · SNDK $1,238.03 (−1.82%) · KOSPI 5,550.30 (+0.30%) · SK hynix ₩1,277,000 (+4.42%)

DDR5 16GB SPOT
$61.27 +0.27% · TrendForce 2026-10-23 18:10 GMT+8 · DDR4 16Gb $82.87 (−0.30%) · NAND 512Gb TLC wafer $18.592 (−1.28% wk, Oct 19)

LEAD STORY

MARKETS · MEMORY AFTER THE ROUT

SK Hynix Jumps 4.4% and Micron Gains 2.5% as Chip Stocks Steady After Thursday's Rout

Memory led a cautious bounce on Friday, helped by the scrapped Solidigm listing. Storage stocks were still sold, and oil near $117 kept a lid on the rest of the market.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · Data as of ~08:30 IDT Saturday · US, Korea and Japan closes final · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · THE CYCLE IN NUMBERS

FRIDAY CLOSES · MEMORY

SK hynix	**₩1,277,000 (+4.42%)**
Samsung Electronics	**₩215,500 (+0.47%)**
Micron	**$877.55 (+2.46%)**
Kioxia	**¥12,755 (+1.27%)**
Sandisk / WDC / Seagate	**−1.82% / −2.97% / −1.81%**

FRIDAY CLOSES · MARKET

SOX	**10,779.46 (+0.44%)**
Nasdaq / S&P 500	**−0.21% / −0.52%**
Kospi (low −2.36% at open)	**5,550.30 (+0.30%)**
WTI / Brent intraday	**$102.96 / $116.99**
US 10-year	**4.994%**

Sources: StockAnalysis, Yahoo Finance, Exa market pages, Yonhap, Korea JoongAng Daily, Nikkei.

Seoul opened Friday down 2.36% and finished up 0.30% at 5,550.30. **SK hynix closed up 4.42% at ₩1,277,000** after opening lower, and Samsung rose 0.47% to ₩215,500. Daishin's Lee Kyoung-min: SK hynix gained "as sentiment improved somewhat following news that Solidigm's IPO plans had been scrapped" (Yonhap). Institutions bought a net ₩596.1 billion of SK hynix while foreigners sold ₩559.7 billion (JoongAng Daily). Breadth was poor, with 716 decliners to 173 advancers, and the Kosdaq fell 1.62%. Kioxia rose 1.27% to ¥12,755, a day after its six-month low (Nikkei).

In New York the SOX rose **0.44%** to 10,779.46, "a pause after Thursday's 30-for-30 selloff" (Cappelleri). Micron gained 2.46% to $877.55. Storage did not join in: Sandisk fell 1.82%, Seagate 1.81% and Western Digital 2.97%. The S&P 500 slipped 0.52% as fresh Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia lifted WTI 3.5% to $102.96, and the 10-year yield sat near 5%. LYNX said the scrapped Solidigm IPO removes an overhang of new NAND capacity, a plus for Micron and Sandisk (Investing.com), and Jensen Huang again rejected glut fears (DIGITIMES).

Our call: late upcycle, tight through 2027, unchanged; a touch tighter on supply discipline (Solidigm, Micron skipping $4F^2$), with the tape steadier but not repaired and storage still sold.

CYCLE SIGNAL: FUNDAMENTALS FIRM, FLOWS STABILIZING

KOREA · HBM SHARE

Bernstein Says Samsung Passed SK Hynix in HBM Revenue Last Quarter

In an Oct. 22 note, Bernstein estimates Samsung's third-quarter HBM revenue at **$8.7 billion, up 33% from the second quarter**, against $7.6 billion for SK hynix, up 11%. If right, Samsung has overtaken SK hynix in HBM revenue. The estimate is built from Korean export data, not company disclosures, so both companies' calls next week are the test: SK hynix at 02:00 IST on Wednesday and Samsung at 03:00 IST on Thursday (Investing.com). For the cycle, a share shift matters less than total HBM supply; for the stocks, it bears on SK hynix's premium. ESTIMATE · SHARE SHIFT

MICRON · TECHNOLOGY AND LABOR

Micron Drops 4F² DRAM, and Its Taoyuan Workers Reject a Revised Bonus Offer

After its Oct. 21 webinar, Micron has officially abandoned the $4F^2$ cell, citing "no viable scaling path," ETNews reported. It will extend $6F^2$, start 1δ mass production in Boise in the second half of 2027, add wafer bonding at 1ε and move to 3D DRAM between 1ζ and 1η. Fewer node transitions mean less disruptive bit growth from Micron, while CXMT is pushing $4F^2$. In Taiwan, **1,633 of 1,637** voting members of the Taoyuan union, about 70% of its 2,300+ members, rejected Micron's profit-sharing proposal and warned of "further collective action." Talks resume Oct. 27 (Straits Times, CNA). Micron makes 50–60% of its chips in Taiwan. SUPPLY DISCIPLINE · LABOR RISK

POLICY · CHINA

Washington Proposes Wider Curbs on U.S. Investment in Chinese Chipmaking

Treasury issued a proposed rule under the COINS Act on Oct. 22 that would require notice of, or prohibit, US investments in Chinese firms working in semiconductors and microelectronics, AI, quantum, supercomputing and hypersonics, with biotechnology added. Final rules will come later (US Treasury). CXMT and YMTC fund their expansion mostly at home, so the near-term effect on Chinese memory supply is small; the direction of policy is the signal. Separately, DIGITIMES reports Nvidia left cooperation with CXMT open. POLICY · WATCH

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE OCT 23, 08:00 IDT

NEW **"The AI overhang is back."** Jefferies' US semis team says fundamentals stay strong, with Lam calling supply the key constraint into 2027, but "we just don't see the group working through earnings." It previews Sandisk, KLA and Intel next week. Jefferies, Oct 23

NEW **A late-cycle tell from analog.** Texas Instruments' 64.2% gross-margin beat fits the pattern of bigger analog EPS upgrades "in the later stages of a semiconductor upcycle." Musk's Terafab target of volume output in late 2028 widens 2028 outcomes for equipment makers. Jefferies, Oct 23

ON X · SINCE LAST EDITION · TIMES IDT

@pequityresearch · Oct 23 21:51
BofA expects Korean memory makers to step up dividends and buybacks on their calls, given very low P/Es and strong FCF growth.
x.com/…/2113704797866017247

@HyperTechInvest · Oct 23 13:31
Micron Taoyuan: 1,633 of 1,637 voting members reject the revised offer; the strike has ended.
x.com/…/2113579126800154720

@pequityresearch · Oct 24 04:12
Gene Munster: the Street models CY27 AI capex +38% after +86% in CY26, and he sees a case for more.
x.com/…/2113800642250571786

@jukan05 · Oct 24 02:07 UNCONFIRMED
Taiwanese media: Intel, AMD and Nvidia prepaid a combined $5B to Taiwanese substrate makers.
x.com/…/2113769187114090509

CYCLE TRACKER · UNCHANGED: A TOUCH TIGHTER ON SUPPLY, TAPE STEADIER

GAUGE	TODAY VS OCT 23 (KPI WATCH LIST)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	No new print; Q4 DRAM ~+20% q/q (TrendForce, carry); Nov contracts due ~month-end	**Slowing**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 $61.27 (+0.27%); DDR4 $82.87 (−0.30%); NAND wafer $18.592 (−1.28% wk)	**Flat**
Lead times	Micron Taoyuan labor risk; substrate prepayments (unconfirmed)	**Tight**
Capex growth	Solidigm IPO and pre-IPO round off; Micron skips 4F^2; Lam: CY27 WFE >$200B (carry)	**Disciplined, 2028 flag**
CXMT supply	US outbound-investment rule proposed; Nvidia leaves CXMT door open	**Rising**
P/E and P/B	SKH +4.4%, MU +2.5% off lows; BofA flags low Korean P/Es	**Cheap, steadier**
Guidance	No new guides; Bernstein: Samsung HBM revenue passed SKH (estimate)	**Firm**

VERDICT
Late upcycle; tight through 2027, unchanged, a touch tighter on supply discipline (Solidigm overhang gone, Micron skipping 4F^2, Taoyuan labor risk). Offsets: flat DRAM spot, soft NAND, storage stocks still sold, Brent near $117 and a 5% 10-year. Next week's SK hynix and Samsung calls are the test.

EVENTS CALENDAR · OCT 24–NOV 7 · ISRAEL TIME (IDT TO OCT 24, IST FROM OCT 25)

Tue 27	Micron Taoyuan union talks · Seagate FQ1 AMC (call 23:00)	HDD
Wed 28	SK hynix 3Q26 call 02:00 · FOMC 20:00 · KLA AMC (call 23:00)	HBM
Thu 29	Samsung 3Q26 call 03:00 · Sandisk FQ1 (call 22:30) · Intel AMC (23:00)	HBM
Fri 30	Tokyo Electron 09:00 · Kioxia 11:45	NAND
Oct 31–Nov 1	CXMT Q3 (by Oct 31) · Korea October exports (Nov 1)	DRAM
Tue Nov 3	Supermicro · AMD AMC (call 00:00 Nov 4; US on EST from Nov 1)	AI

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Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #18 · Oct 24, 2026